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Surendran Reddy's *Mayibuye Suite* (2001): Reimagining of the Organ in a Contemporary South

African Composition – May 2026

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Abstract

The music of the South African composer Surendran Reddy (1962–2010) represents a distinctive synthesis of Western classical traditions, jazz idioms, and African musical influences. His *Mayibuye Suite* (2001) for organ exemplifies this stylistic hybridity and offers an important contribution to contemporary organ repertoire. Drawing on analytical frameworks derived from jazz theory and contemporary music analysis, this article examines the suite's three movements - *Prelude*, *An African Hymn*, and *Toccata* – with particular emphasis on harmonic language, rhythmic processes, and stylistic synthesis. The study situates the work within the broader cultural and socio-political context of post-apartheid South Africa and Reddy's own artistic philosophy, encapsulated in his concept of *clazz*, a fusion of classical and jazz idioms. The findings demonstrate how the *Mayibuye Suite* reimagines the expressive possibilities of the organ, transforming the instrument into a medium for intercultural musical dialogue while reflecting themes of displacement, cultural identity, and artistic hybridity.